

GeoNews — Week 38/2026

Weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 18 September 2026

What is GeoNews? An **automatically generated weekly digest**. A research workflow scans the publications of the past one to two weeks along with funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria, and assembles this issue from them.

The thematic profile is **aligned with the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and non-linear time-series analysis. Anyone working in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete survey of the Quaternary sciences.

Selection, scoring and short texts are produced by machine and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; in case of doubt the linked original source prevails.

Each paper receives a score from 0–100 across five criteria: thematic proximity (40), methodological proximity (25), impact/venue (15), connectivity (10) and recency (10). Categories: ● from 75 must-read · ● 50–74 relevant · ● 30–49 radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and prioritises reading — it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

Eighteen scored papers, and **two ● must-reads** this week. At the top is a peer-reviewed, open-access *Communications Earth & Environment* study of **Holocene summer and winter temperatures in East-Central Europe** from five Carpathian pollen records: separate seasonal reconstructions over the last 12,000 years, statistically tested for trends and short excursions — directly

connective to Quaternary time-series questions. Behind it a hydrological-fluvial study of a **Holocene extreme flood on the Danjiang River (central China)**, reconstructed from slackwater deposits in a loess-palaeosol sequence — the same methodological question as in Central European palaeoflood studies.

The ● block is broad this week: palaeoceanographic reconstructions (Holocene Labrador Current variability, boron-isotope deep-Arctic ventilation during the last glacial), lake and lake-level archives (an arid Central Asian lake-level record, Great Basin fire/climate, a Late Glacial paired-lake approach on the Swiss Plateau), a human-environment study from the Levantine corridor, and a deglacial moraine chronology in Ireland. The radar list adds monsoon, loess and speleothem archives; regionally noteworthy are a new **East Turkana geochronology (Buluk, Kenya)** and a geomorphology study from the Tanganyika-Kivu rift segment.

On how this issue came about — with full literature access this week. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as usual (proxy 403); the Crossref query,

however, ran successfully in this run via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()`), so the systematic ISSN query of the core journals **including Elsevier, Wiley and the Nature family** could be carried out — markedly broader coverage than in the recent open-access-only weeks. Elsevier still provides no abstracts; those titles are marked $\triangle$ *title-based* and their content stands provisionally.

On funding, the next dates come in quick succession: the **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 (29 Sep 2026)**, the **DFG Communicator Award 2027 (30 Sep 2026)**, the **DEUQUA meeting** in Freiburg (**28 Sep–2 Oct 2026**) and the **ERC Starting Grant 2027 (14 Oct 2026)**. In science policy, the **WissZeitVG amendment** has had its first reading after the summer recess and been referred to the Committee on Education, Research and Technology Assessment.

Part A — Papers of the week

Captured were papers with a Crossref `created` date from 4 September 2026 onward that were not already listed in an earlier issue. DOIs already listed are excluded. For every entry with a consultable abstract the assessment relies on that abstract; titles without an available abstract (mainly Elsevier) are marked $\triangle$ *title-based*.

● Must-read (from 75)

1. Holocene summer and winter temperature trends and excursions in East-Central Europe from Carpathian pollen records · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 ·

Score 88 A reconstruction of separate summer and winter temperatures for East-Central Europe over the last 12,000 years from pollen records at five mid-altitude Carpathian sites. The seasonal series are combined into composite records and statistically evaluated for long-term trends and short excursions. Finding, per the abstract: both seasons show strong Early Holocene warming, then diverge — summer temperature peaks at 7.2 ka (about 1.4 °C above the Holocene mean) and then declines, while winter temperature keeps rising to a Late Holocene maximum at 2.1 ka (about 1.7 °C above the mean) before falling over the last two millennia. The authors read the opposing trends as a progressive reduction in continentality across the region over the last 6,000 years; the 8.2 ka event is the only statistically significant short excursion (about –2 °C in summer, –2.4 °C in winter). Squarely in the profile core (Quaternary palaeoclimate reconstruction) and methodologically connective: separating seasonal signals and statistically detecting trends and excursions in long proxy time series is the same tool-level question that is central to tipping-point and transition analysis. Open access (Nature Portfolio). *Theme 38* · *Method 20* · *Venue 12* · *Connectivity 8* · *Recency 10* (publ. 14 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-04041-6](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-04041-6)

2. Hydrological reconstruction and climatic background of the Holocene extreme paleoflood event in the Danjiang River, central China · *Open Geosciences*, 2026 · **Score 87**

A paleoflood reconstruction in the Danjiang basin, the water source for the middle route of China's South-to-North Water Diversion. At the Dihua site (Danfeng) a Holocene loess-palaeosol sequence with an embedded slackwater deposit (SWD) was identified. Proxies such as magnetic susceptibility and grain-size distribution show, per the abstract, that the SWD formed by settling of suspended sediment in a relatively stagnant depositional environment; paleoflood hydrology extends the basin's Holocene flood record as a basis for flood-risk management and operations. A core profile theme (paleofloods and fluvial geomorphology) with high connectivity: reconstructing extreme discharges from slackwater sediments is methodologically the same

question as in Central European palaeoflood studies (including the Ahr). The weakest term is the venue value (a smaller journal); thematic and methodological proximity carry the score. *Theme 40 · Method 22 · Venue 5 · Connectivity 10 · Recency 10 (publ. 15 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1515/geo-2025-1015](https://doi.org/10.1515/geo-2025-1015)*

● Relevant (50-74)

3. Long-term ecological stability in the Pleistocene central Levantine corridor revealed by enamel isotopes from Lebanon · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 72**
Sequential and bulk $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ and $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ enamel values from eight herbivore species at three Lebanese sites (Naame, Nahr Ibrahim, Ras el-Kelb), spanning about 400,000 to 100,000 years ago. The Levant was a repeatedly used dispersal corridor for hominins, including the expansion of modern humans out of Africa. Finding, per the abstract: the central Levant maintained a remarkably stable Mediterranean seasonality across multiple glacial-interglacial cycles — consistent summer-winter offsets and minimal change in amplitude despite pronounced regional and global climatic oscillations. Connective as a Quaternary human-environment study (Tier 2): seasonally resolved isotopes reconstructing vegetation, hydrology and temperature regime touch the same multiproxy question as continental climate archives, here through biogenic carbonate rather than sediment. *Theme 28 · Method 15 · Venue 12 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10 (publ. 14 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-03925-x](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-03925-x)*

4. Contrasting lake-level dynamics drive divergent ecological trajectories in arid Central Asian lakes since 1800 CE · *Global and Planetary Change*, 2026 · **Score 72** ·  *title-based* A comparison of lake-level dynamics in arid Central Asian lakes since 1800 and their divergent ecological trajectories. A core profile theme (lake-level and water-balance archives), transferable to water-balance modelling of East African rift basins, where the same coupling of precipitation-evaporation, lake level and ecological state is central. Without a consultable abstract (Elsevier), the assessment rests on title, journal and topical relevance; the specific methods and quantitative finding stand provisionally. *Theme 36 · Method 14 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 6 (publ. 09 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105709](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105709)*

5. Alternative savanna states during the Last Interglacial: non-eucalypt dominance in northern Australia's monsoon tropics · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 70** ·  *title-based* A reconstruction of alternative savanna states during the Last Interglacial in northern Australia's monsoon tropics, with a title-stated dominance of non-eucalypt vegetation. Thematically Quaternary (monsoon dynamics, ecosystem states) and conceptually connective to tipping-point and multistability questions: the existence of alternative vegetation states under interglacial boundary conditions is the same question of non-linear system response that is also discussed for African humid phases. Without a consultable abstract (Elsevier), hence title-based and provisional. *Theme 30 · Method 12 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10 (publ. 15 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110269](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110269)*

6. Responses of primary producers, anoxia, and chemical feedback to Late Glacial climate change: Insights from a paired lake approach · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 70** An investigation of the responses of primary producers, stratification and nutrient cycling in a small Central European lake (Übeschisee, Swiss Plateau) to rapid climate change during Late Glacial times (17–11 ka). Finding, per the abstract: after 16.2 ka (Heinrich Stadial 1) and during the Bølling/Allerød interstadial, natural eutrophication followed summer warming and vegetation development in the catchment; anoxia events with sulfur-bacteria blooms systematically established during colder phases (HS1 around 16.5 ka, Older Dryas around 14 ka, Gerzensee Oscillation around 13.2 ka, Younger Dryas 12.7–11.7 ka). Connective as a Central

European lake-sediment and multiproxy study (Tier 2): the coupling of rapid climate change to eutrophication, deoxygenation and feedback is methodologically the same question of lake response to abrupt transitions that is central in continental water-balance archives. *Theme 30 · Method 18 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 6 (publ. 10 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70115](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70115)*

7. Fire, fuel, and climate in the Great Basin from the Middle Holocene to present from the sediments of Blue Lake, NV · *Quaternary Research*, 2026 · Score 69 A high-resolution lake-sediment record from the Great Basin combining physical sedimentology with charcoal analysis to document lake level and biomass burning over the past 7,000 years. Finding, per the abstract: persistently low lake levels in the Middle Holocene (7,000–4,000 cal BP), two pronounced low stands (4,200–3,800 and 2,600–2,400 cal BP) during documented episodes of abrupt environmental change; the first principal component of the scanning-XRF data (over 75 % of the variance) correlates significantly with a bristlecone-pine temperature reconstruction, suggesting warmer temperatures as a major driver of the reduced precipitation–evaporation balance. Spectral analysis shows interannual and multidecadal periodicities typical of the Pacific ocean–atmosphere system. Connective via lake-level/water-balance and the spectral time-series analysis. *Theme 30 · Method 18 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 6 (publ. 09 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10114](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10114)*

8. Boron Isotope Evidence for Reduced Ventilation of the Deep Arctic Ocean During the Last Glacial Period · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · Score 66 A palaeo-pH reconstruction of the deep Arctic Ocean over the last 45,000 years compared with a surface record from the Nordic Seas. Finding, per the abstract: the pH difference between the surface Nordic Seas and the deep Arctic Ocean was larger during the Last Glacial Period (45–11 ka) than in the early and middle Holocene (11–5 ka), pointing to reduced glacial ventilation of the deep Arctic via the surface Nordic Seas. Connective as a Quaternary palaeoceanography study (Tier 2): deep-ocean ventilation controls the storage of ocean carbon and touches the same carbon-cycle question that is central to glacial CO₂ decompositions. *Theme 25 · Method 16 · Venue 9 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (publ. 17 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005533](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005533)*

9. Labrador Coastal Current Variability During the Holocene · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · Score 66 A reconstruction of Holocene flow speeds of the Labrador Coastal Current using the sortable-silt index at two core sites off northern and central Labrador. Finding, per the abstract: similar speeds through time at both sites, controlled by Hudson Bay outflow, with a roughly 1,500-year cyclicity consistent with the Arctic Oscillation; surface sediments suggest a recent increase in current velocity, consistent with increased Arctic freshwater export and a possible recent weakening of the Atlantic meridional overturning circulation. Connective as a Holocene, cyclicity-oriented palaeoceanography study (Tier 2). *Theme 25 · Method 16 · Venue 9 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (publ. 17 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005586](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005586)*

10. The West Corrib moraine system as evidence for a brief glacial readvance in Ireland during overall Heinrich Stadial 1 deglaciation · *Quaternary Research*, 2026 · Score 64 Geomorphic mapping, sedimentology and cosmogenic ¹⁰Be surface-exposure dating of an end-moraine system in the western Lough Corrib basin, Ireland. Finding, per the abstract: the West Corrib moraine system was deposited around 16.5 ka by ice flowing east out of Connemara and marks a brief period of ice-marginal stability or readvance that interrupted the overall deglaciation during Heinrich Stadial 1 (18.2–14.7 ka) — despite the moraines' topographic prominence, the event was short-lived relative to the roughly 3,000-year duration of HS1. Connective as a deglacial chronology of a brief, abrupt readvance. *Theme 25 · Method 15 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (publ. 16 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10091](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10091)*

● Radar

- **Chironomid-based Holocene summer temperature variability in Lake Prokoško, Vranica Mountains, Bosnia and Hercegovina** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **64** ● · △ *title-based* · Chironomid-based reconstruction of summer temperature variability from a Western Balkan mountain lake; noted as a Central-European-connective lake-sediment study. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110255](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110255) · publ. 10 Sep 2026
- **Changing hydroclimate seasonality in SW Iberia over the Last Deglaciation and Holocene revealed using leaf-wax isotopes** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **62** ● · △ *title-based* · Leaf-wax isotopes for hydroclimate seasonality across the deglaciation and Holocene in SW Iberia. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110254](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110254) · publ. 10 Sep 2026
- **Hydroclimate complexity across the last glacial cycle in tropical Australia: reassessing the uniqueness of the Holocene** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **61** ● · △ *title-based* · Reassessment of hydroclimatic variability across the last glacial cycle in tropical Australia. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110253](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110253) · publ. 10 Sep 2026
- **Contrasting responses of the eastern and western Chinese Loess Plateau to Heinrich events** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **60** ● · △ *title-based* · Contrasting response of the eastern and western Loess Plateau to Heinrich events; noted as a millennial-abrupt study. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110260](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110260) · publ. 04 Sep 2026
- **Holocene vegetation dynamics of Grande Terre (Kerguelen Islands) inferred from sedimentary ancient DNA** · *Journal of Quaternary Science* · **59** ● · Sedimentary ancient DNA (sedaDNA) over the past ~11,080 years; a vegetation shift around 8,700 cal BP coincides with a pollen-inferred northward shift of the Southern Hemisphere Westerlies. Noted as a subantarctic multiproxy palaeoecology study. DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70101](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70101) · publ. 10 Sep 2026
- **Differential responses of Asian summer monsoon circulation and local hydroclimate during the Holocene** · *Quaternary International* · **59** ● · △ *title-based* · A decoupling of large-scale monsoon circulation and local hydroclimate during the Holocene. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110454](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110454) · publ. 16 Sep 2026
- **Dansgaard-Oeschger cycles of the penultimate glacial period recorded in a stalagmite from northern China** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology* · **56** ● · △ *title-based* · A speleothem record of millennial Dansgaard-Oeschger cycles of the penultimate glacial. No consultable abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114197](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114197) · publ. 03 Sep 2026
- **Geochronology and sedimentology / Terrestrial palaeoenvironments and palaeoclimate — Buluk fossil site, East Turkana, Kenya (Miocene climate optimum)** · *Geological Society of America Bulletin* · **52** ● · △ *title-based* · Two paired papers on the geochronology/sedimentology and terrestrial palaeoenvironments of a hominoid-bearing site in East Turkana. Geographically in the profile core (East African Rift / Turkana), but Miocene in age (deep-time) — hence listed as a regional radar item. DOI: [10.1130/b38609.1](https://doi.org/10.1130/b38609.1) · [10.1130/b38610.1](https://doi.org/10.1130/b38610.1) · publ. 18 Sep 2026

Regional and methodological margin: a geomorphology study of deep-seated landslides in the northern Tanganyika-Kivu rift segment (*Geomorphology*, **46** ●, △ *title-based*, publ. 14 Sep 2026, DOI: [10.1016/j.geomorph.2026.110546](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.geomorph.2026.110546)) touches the rift region but stays methodologically (slope stability, Tier 3) at the margin; the water-balance reanalysis dataset **HERA-WB** for Europe 1951–2020 (*ESSD* preprint, **45** ●, publ. 03 Sep 2026, DOI: [10.5194/essd-2026-674](https://doi.org/10.5194/essd-2026-674)) is instrumental-

hydrological rather than palaeoclimatic in topic, but methodologically noteworthy for water-balance questions.

Outside the window but thematically relevant: the much-discussed Nature Geoscience *Analysis* "Planetary energy budget during abrupt glacial climate events set by Atlantic Ocean heat valve" (Buizert et al., DOI: [10.1038/s41561-026-02070-6](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41561-026-02070-6)) argues that AMOC strength acts as a "heat valve" on the planetary energy budget during abrupt glacial climate events. It is dated 10 Aug 2026 and thus falls outside the 14-day window; the accompanying *Research Briefing* (DOI: [10.1038/s41561-026-02086-y](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41561-026-02086-y), 7 Sep 2026) is a summary format and does not count as a primary study. Mentioned for context, not listed as a new publication of the week.

Part B — Funding & calls

PAGES — Early-Career Award 2027, deadline 29 Sep 2026. The award recognises outstanding early-career researchers (PhD completed or postdoc, generally within five years of the PhD; justified career breaks extend this) for excellent science combined with coordination, outreach and community engagement; the prize includes an invitation to present at the Open Science Meeting plus a conference grant. The previous **workshop and working-group funding round (deadline 11 Sep 2026) has passed**; a new regular deadline is not yet published (PAGES usually calls twice a year). Endorsement requests (without funding) are assessed in January, April, July and October. Sources: [PAGES — Early-Career Award 2027](#) · [PAGES — Workshop/ meeting support](#).

ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 14 Oct 2026. The call (ERC-2027-STG) has been open since 22 Jul 2026 (submission by 14 Oct 2026, 17:00 Brussels time). Funding up to EUR 1.5 million over five years (plus up to EUR 1 million for start-up/equipment); an indicative 2027 call budget of about EUR 594 million with an estimated 373 grants. Step-1 results in April 2027, interviews and Step-2 results in August 2027. The eligibility window has been adjusted for 2027; the official ERC page is authoritative. Sources: [ERC — Starting Grant](#) · [ERC — Applying in the 2027 competitions](#).

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opens **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, budget about **EUR 14 million for roughly two projects**, i.e. some EUR 7 million per consortium. Aim per the call text: robust information on palaeoclimate states and events outside the variability of recent centuries, as a basis for advancing Earth system models. With only two projects funded Europe-wide the competition is fierce; consortium talks should be started early. Sources: [Topic page](#) · [CL5 Work Programme 2026–2027 \(PDF\)](#).

ICDP — proposal cycle. The regular annual deadline for full, pre- and workshop proposals is **15 January**; the 2027 cycle is likely to follow the same pattern, though no formal announcement has appeared. Workshop calls run through the year. Source: [ICDP — Proposals](#).

DFG — changed framework conditions. No new palaeoclimate-specific call. Relevant for planning: the **programme allowance rises from 22 to 25 percent from 2027**; the next **Priority Programme application round** will only take place at the **end of 2026**, with funding starting from **2028**. Applications for the **DFG Communicator Award 2027** (science communication) remain open until **30 Sep 2026**. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — 25 instead of 22 percent from 2027](#) · [DFG — Press releases 2026](#).

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — amendment debated at first reading, now in committee. Following the cabinet decision of 29 Jul 2026, the bill to modernise fixed-term employment law in science had its first reading in the Bundestag after the summer recess and was referred to the **Committee on Education, Research and Technology Assessment** for further deliberation. At its core are, for the first time, binding **minimum contract durations: three years for doctoral researchers' first contracts, two years for postdocs**; the maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase is **standardised at six years**. For **student research assistants** the draft provides a minimum term of one year and raises the maximum fixed-term duration from six to eight years. As interpretation, not established fact: minimum durations improve the predictability of early contracts, while standardising the postdoc maximum narrows individual carry-over flexibility; the further parliamentary path and timetable are open. Sources: [BMFTR — Cabinet adopts amendment to the WissZeitVG](#) · [Bundestag — Reform of the Wissenschaftszeitvertragsgesetz](#) · [Forschung & Lehre — WissZeitVG focus](#).

Federal budget 2027 — cabinet decision of 6 Jul 2026, parliamentary debate in the autumn. The government draft has stood since 6 July 2026. The BMFTR core budget is about **EUR 22 billion** — a nominal increase of only about **0.7 percent** over 2026. Real increases are almost exclusively in the special fund for infrastructure and climate neutrality, whose R&D investments rise markedly in 2027 over 2026. The first Bundestag reading is due in the autumn. As interpretation: the regular budget stagnates in real terms given current pay and materials cost rises, keeping the operating situation of the funding organisations under pressure. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — Only a slim increase for the BMFTR core budget](#) · [Table.Briefings — Budget 2027](#).

DFG cuts at the postdoc level remain in force. Owing to high pay rises and increased equipment and consumables costs that the promised annual funding increments do not cover, the DFG has postponed the funding start of new Research Training Group applications and **suspended the approval of postdoc positions**. For postdoc career paths in the geosciences this removes a funding route for now, increasing the pressure on individual-grant and EU funds. Source: [Fakultätentag Informatik](#).

Part D — Community & dates

- **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 — 29 Sep 2026.** The PAGES workshop/working-group round (11 Sep 2026) has passed; the next regular deadline is still open.
- **DFG Communicator Award 2027 — deadline 30 Sep 2026.**
- **DEUQUA meeting 2026 — 28 Sep to 2 Oct 2026 in Freiburg im Breisgau**, theme "Environmental Records and Landscape Change", with full-day excursions on 28 Sep and 2 Oct (Black Forest/Vosges glaciation, Rhine Valley loess, fluvial dynamics in the Upper Rhine Graben, among others). Source: [DEUQUA 2026](#).
- **ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 14 Oct 2026.**
- **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call — opens 17 Nov 2026, deadline 4 Mar 2027.**
- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026 — 7-11 Dec 2026 in San Francisco**; the abstract deadline (5 Aug 2026) has passed. Source: [AGU](#).

- **EGU General Assembly 2027 — 4 to 9 Apr 2027 in Vienna**, hybrid. Abstract deadline not yet published; typically mid-January. Source: [EGU](#).
 - **ICDP** — next regular proposal deadline expected **15 Jan 2027**, following previous years and not yet confirmed.
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Methods & sources

The paper review follows the fixed set of criteria (thematic proximity, methodological proximity, impact/venue, connectivity, recency) and excludes DOIs already listed in an earlier issue. Funding opportunities, science policy and dates rely on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

On how this issue came about — Crossref access via the browser interface. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as in previous weeks (proxy 403). The Crossref REST API was, however, queried successfully in this run via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()` against `api.crossref.org`). This allowed the systematic ISSN query of the core journals (including QSR, EPSL, GPC, P³, Quaternary Research, JQS, Quaternary International, Paleooceanography and Paleoclimatology, the Nature family) with a `from-created-date` filter and `created` sorting, complemented by topic queries and a preprint scan (posted-content). For Nature-Portfolio titles without a Crossref abstract, the publisher landing page was consulted.

What this means for coverage. Coverage is broader this week than in the open-access-only weeks and again includes the Elsevier and Wiley core journals. Elsevier still provides no abstracts via Crossref; those entries are marked $\triangle$ *title-based*, their content stands provisionally pending sight of the original, and no results were invented beyond the title. The dates given are Crossref `created` dates (registration), which may differ from the online publication date by a few days. A direct African East-Africa / rift / AHP primary hit with a Quaternary focus was not findable within the window; the region is served this week through a Miocene East Turkana geochronology (Buluk) and a rift geomorphology study (Tanganyika-Kivu). For context, a thematically relevant but out-of-window Nature Geoscience Analysis (AMOC "heat valve", 10 Aug 2026) was checked and excluded.

GeoNews is an automatically generated digest, published by Dr Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no connection to the publishers or funding bodies named, and constitutes no recommendation or advice. Corrections and tips are welcome.